

When we combined AI with ancient stories

One of the most ambitious projects I have worked on involved building a cinematic universe rooted in Indian mythology and culture. We decided to combine human creativity with artificial intelligence.

Our team fed the AI models with thousands of years of folklore, character archetypes, and traditional plot structures. But the story itself, like the arcs, emotional beats, and the twists came from us. AI simply helped us do it faster.

What we created was more than just a script. It was a living, breathing fictional world, designed for future adaptation into augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) experiences. I am confident it will appear on screens within the next few years.

The day I was arrested by my own characters

Every good story has a twist, and mine came during the International Film Festival of Kerala. I was creating a live comic generated in real time using AI, when I was unexpectedly arrested by characters I had created.

This surreal event became a metaphor for just how immersive and unpredictable storytelling can be. It was also a personal reminder that as storytellers, we often become part of the very worlds we create.

The coupe glass that travelled the world

One of my favourite projects came from an unusual brief. A bar owner, Sidecar's Minakshi Singh, approached me with a story idea, but insisted there be no human characters. That constraint sparked our imagination.

We created a story from the perspective of a coupe glass. This glass travelled through 12 countries, collecting flavours and experiences. It finally found its place on the menu at Sidecar in Delhi. If you visit the bar,

you will see that coupe glass featured as the protagonist. That story even won us an award at one of the largest AI storytelling conferences.

The tools I use (and why I stopped building my own)

Like many others, I once tried building my own large language model (LLM). It was a typical startup decision. But I soon realised that the pace of advancement in AI was too fast. By the time we built something, it would already be outdated.

So I shifted focus. Today, I use tools like Gemini AI Studio's application programming interface (API), and the most advanced models from ChatGPT. These tools help us move quickly. But what sets us apart is the human input like the nuance, emotion, and the structure.

One challenge we faced was maintaining character consistency in AI-generated visuals. To address this, we have built an internal platform that streamlines everything from writing to final output.

The question of ownership

One question I am asked often is: who owns AI-generated content? It is a legal grey area. While we are consulting intellectual property experts, I believe that the narrative — the soul of the story — belongs to us. The AI may assist, but the creative direction comes from human minds.

As legislation catches up with technology, I hope we find frameworks that protect creators while still encouraging innovation.

Democratising storytelling

I believe the future of storytelling is as widespread as coding. Just as no-code platforms have enabled millions to create apps, AI tools will allow anyone to tell stories, whether through comics, films, or immersive experiences.

At Script Factory and Naadan Comics, we are already working with

brands, creators, and event organisers to bring stories to life in unconventional ways. One project involves helping founders visualise their minimum viable product (MVP) as a comic instead of a technical document. We are simplifying a lot of complex topics and one such space is systems thinking for schools, colleges and think tanks through card games. This helps teams and investors understand the product quickly, and with greater emotional clarity.

However, just like in cooking, while everyone can tell a story, not everyone can tell a great one. The real skill lies in knowing how to structure, pace, and flavour the story! Where to pause, where to surprise, and how to land the final moment.

My advice to the next generation

To those wondering whether this emerging field is worth pursuing, I would say 'Yes' without hesitation. Storytelling, especially when combined with technology, is one of the most exciting spaces today.

There is still room to define what this industry will look like. If you are observant, empathetic, and curious, you have all the raw material you need. Learn from people. Study history. Listen closely. That is how you become a storyteller.

Technology will change. Tools will come and go. But the human desire to share experiences and ideas? That is timeless.

We have moved from cave paintings to software modules. Artificial intelligence is just the latest tool. At our core, we still want the same thing: to tell a story that others will remember. **END** 🐧

The article is based on a talk titled 'AI in Storytelling' by Kamalakkannan Durairaju, founder of Script Factory, at AI DevCon 2025 in Bengaluru.

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